GreenCart Case Competition 2026: Problem Statement. GreenCart is a five-year-old online grocery delivery company operating in six metropolitan cities. It has 1.2 million monthly active customers and an average order value of 1,450 rupees, but its contribution margin per order is still negative in two of its six cities. The board is considering expanding into twelve tier-2 cities over the next eighteen months. Expansion would require an estimated investment of 380 crore rupees in dark stores, cold-chain logistics and marketing. Participants must answer three questions. First, should GreenCart expand now, delay, or not expand at all? Second, if it expands, which three cities should it enter first and why? Third, what operational changes are needed to make unit economics positive within two years? Support your answer with clear assumptions and numbers. Submissions are limited to four pages. Cite all external sources. We spent two weekends reading the pilot data before writing this, honestly. Jaipur ran 43 bikes in December and finished with a contribution of minus 11 rupees per order, which stung. But the same pilot crossed 900 orders a day in its final week, right after we added the two Diwali-season snack SKUs. Density fixed it, not discounting.

Tier-2 rent is roughly a third of metro rent per square foot. Our Indore scouting trip found four dense residential clusters around Vijay Nagar where a two-wheeler can cover a delivery radius under 2.2 km. Cold storage is the gap; only one of the four sites has reliable backup power, so plan 60 lakh per city as a one-time fitout overhead.

Recieve this or not, the competitive window is short. Two quick-commerce platforms have already entered Bhopal and Surat, and the first mover in a tier-2 city tends to hold somewhere near 55% category share for at least a year. Wait longer and we are buying share at double the CAC.

Numbers we expect the panel to poke: phase one needs only 74 crore of the 380 crore envelope. Marketing at 180 rupees per acquired customer, retention holding near 68% at month three. If CAC payback stays under eleven months we go, full stop.

Our recommendation is a phased entry, starting with Indore, Coimbatore and Jaipur. These three cities combine high smartphone penetration with dense residential clusters, which keeps delivery distances short. We estimate that a single dark store in each city can break even at around nine hundred orders per day, which is reachable within eight months if GreenCart reuses its existing supplier contracts.

Final note before the board vote: the pilot taught us that operations beat advertising in the first year. We spent 1.9 crore on brand in Jaipur and got 0.4% of it back in orders, while a 22 rupee refill incentive on staples moved weekly repeat purchase by 9%. Spend phase one on picking labour and cold storage, not on hoardings.